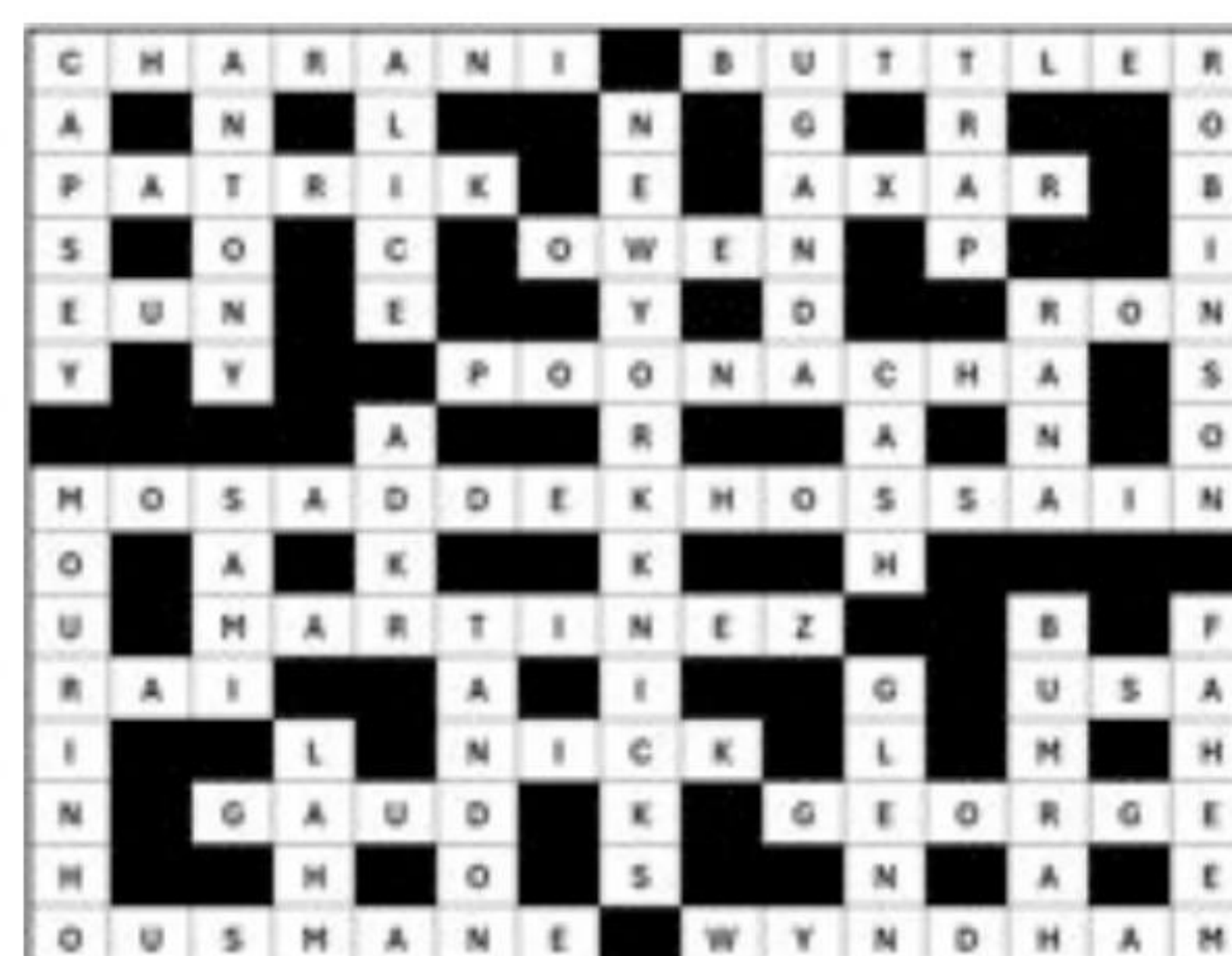
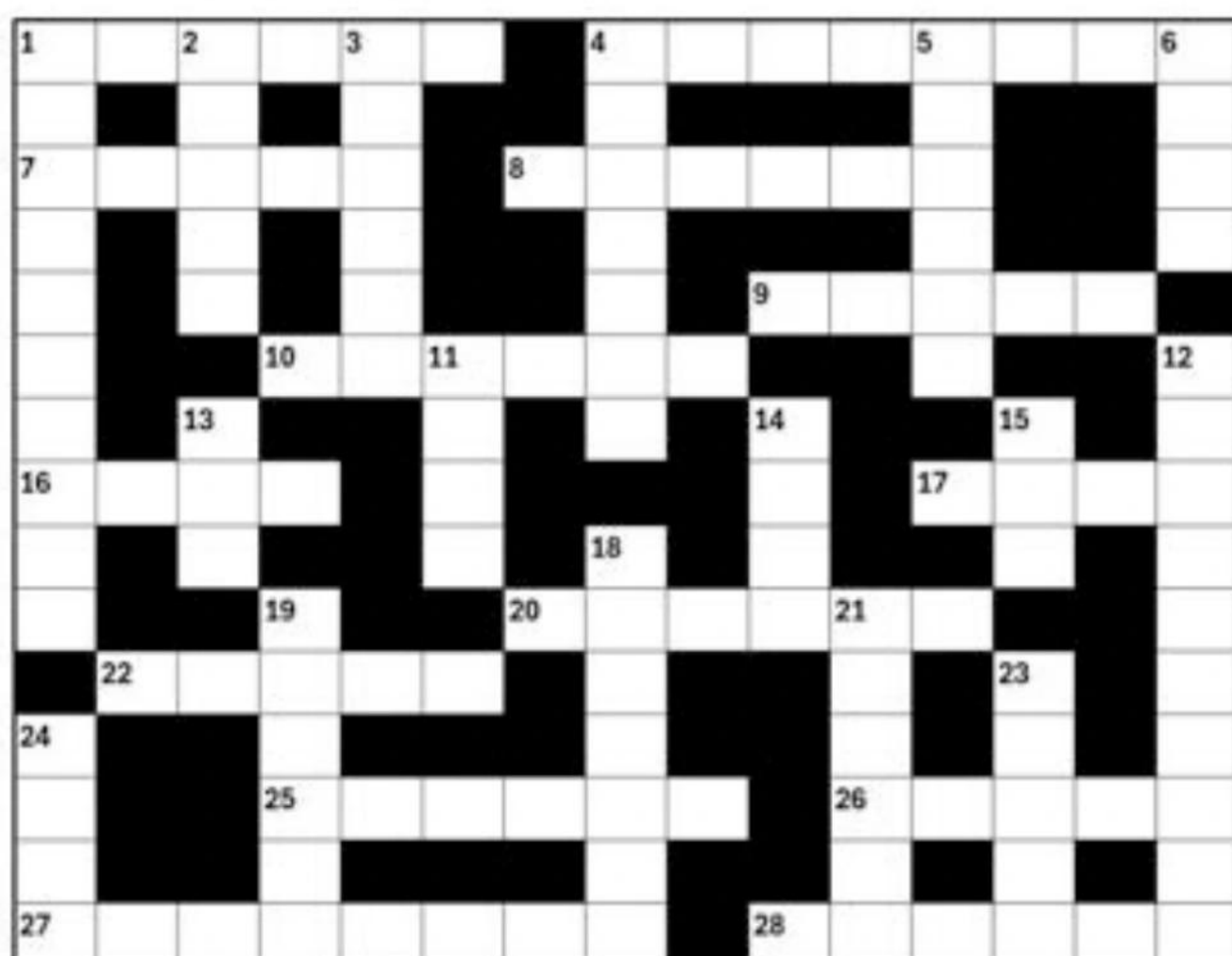


CROSSWORD

N. SOORYA PRAKASH



SOLUTION TO LAST FORTNIGHT'S CROSSWORD

FIFA WORLD CUP 2026 SPECIAL

ACROSS

- 1 Identify this Ecuadorian defender playing for AC Milan, who came in as a substitute in the group match versus Germany. (6)
- 4 Identify the surname of this Dutch footballer, who turned out to be the oldest coach in FIFA World Cup 2026. (8)
- 7 Identify the surname of this German who scored three goals, all as a substitute. (5)
- 8 & 27 Who scored the first goal of FIFA World Cup 2026? (6,8)
- 9 Identify the surname of this Spaniard who created the second-most chances by a player in the final of FIFA World Cup. (5)
- 10 Identify the first name of the Algerian goalkeeper. (6)
- 16 Identify the surname of the Curacao goalkeeper. (4)
- 17 Identify the surname of the Spaniard who assisted in his team's second goal in the semifinal against France. (4)
- 20 Which city's football club does Livano Comenencia play for? He scored Curacao's historic first-ever World Cup goal. (6)
- 22 Identify the surname of this Belgian who was South Africa's coach. (5)
- 25 Identify the surname of Canada's captain. (6)
- 26 FTB: New Zealand's Elijah Just who

scored two goals in the group match versus Iran is of _____ country origin. (5)

- 28 Which country created history by becoming the first to host the FIFA World Cup tournament three times. (6)

DOWN

- 1 Who won the FIFA Young Player award? (3,7)
- 2 Who won the Golden Ball award? (5)
- 3 Identify the surname of this Australian who scored a successful penalty in the loss against Egypt in the Round of 32. (6)
- 4 Identify the first name of this Uruguayan who scored his team's second goal in the group match versus Cape Verde. (7)
- 5 Which country beat last edition's host Qatar 6-0 in a group match? (6)
- 6 Identify the first name of this referee who made history by becoming the first American woman to serve as a head referee at a men's World Cup. (4)
- 11 Identify the first name of the successful Spanish team's coach. (4)
- 12 Which American woman referee assisted DOWN-6 in the Group A match between Czech Republic and South Africa? (6,4)
- 13 Identify the first name of South Korea's captain. (3)
- 14 Identify the first name of the player

who won the Golden Glove award. (4)

- 15 Identify the first name of this footballer who scored the equaliser for Jordan in the Group J encounter versus Austria. (3)
- 18 Identify the surname of this Australian who scored an own goal in the Group D match against USA. (7)
- 19 Out of the four countries which made their World Cup debuts, which one scored in all its games? (6)
- 21 Identify the first name of this Belgian pro-league club in which Ivorian Oumar Diakite plays? (6)
- 23 Which country from the CONCACAF confederation returned to World Cup in 2026 after its only previous appearance in 1974? (5)
- 24 Which country from the AFC confederation returned to World Cup in 2026 after the only previous appearance in 1986? (4)